



GDD 25 MythBuster: Gender

Bust the myths, check the facts

The teen gender-myth game for ages 12-15, a flagship of the strike-and-rewrite signature. It busts the pseudo-scientific gender claims teens hear constantly, with real evidence, evenhandedly, and never anti-boy. Equality, it shows, frees everyone. Seven mechanics, 31 myth-flips, zero "tap the right card". Scorecard: passed.

Bust the myths, check the facts.

MythBuster: Gender takes the gender thread into the teen years, busting the confident gender myths 12-15s hear constantly, often dressed as "science" or "just facts" from the worst corners of the internet. It deepens Norm Storm (g18) and stands beside Flip the Script (g17) as a flagship of the strike-and-rewrite signature. Its tone is deliberate: evidence-based, evenhanded, and never anti-boy, because rigid gender myths hurt boys too, and equality frees everyone. New v2 build.

FIELD	VALUE
Node / gameld	g25 · mythbuster-gender (confirm exact id against engine-host)
Chapter / ages	Chapter 4 · ages 12-15 · real / evidence-based
Thread / topics	E · Gender & Respect · UNESCO 3.1, 3.2
Prerequisite / builds on	g24 (Green Light / Red Light) · builds on g18 (Norm Storm)
Gating	Core
Schema / status	v2 · scorecard PASS a strike-and-rewrite flagship.

90

scenarios

7

mechanics

31

myth-flips

18

choice & voice

0%

binary taps

Evenhanded by design. This is the gentle counter to the "manosphere" pipeline, so it never attacks boys. It takes boys' real struggles seriously, shows how rigid gender myths pressure them too (provide alone, never cry), and frames equality as a win for everyone, not "men lose". And it meets "it's just science" with actual science, plus the naturalistic fallacy: even a real average difference never proves what's fair.

For the kid being fed myths.

From the Chapter 4 personas. By 12-15, teens, especially boys like Veer, get a stream of confident gender "facts" from feeds and mates; this game answers them with evidence, before those sources define the world for them.

PERSONA	WHAT THEY NEED HERE	THE MECHANIC THAT SERVES IT
Veer, 14 (absorbing online gender "facts")	Real evidence, and to see the myths pressure him too.	strike-rewrite + spot : bust it; spot the agenda.
Riya, 15	Proof that ability and leadership aren't gendered.	strike-rewrite + match : counter-examples.
Rohit (a dad)	To back his kids' talents beyond gender; share the home.	sort + match : roles aren't gendered.
The Counsellor	To help teens fact-check a science-y claim.	branch : check the evidence.
Every teen	A radar for gender myths in the wild.	spot + role-play : spot it, flip it.

Why this works (the evidence). There's no robust "male brain / female brain" split for ability, studies find no gender difference in maths-processing brain networks, and the maths gap shrinks where equality is higher, it's culture and teaching, not biology. Counter-examples abound: India has a woman President, had a woman Prime Minister, and the 2023 Women's Reservation Act reserves a third of legislative seats for women. And rigid myths harm boys too, while "it's natural" never proves something is right, the naturalistic fallacy.

Seven moves, led by the flip.

Teen gender beliefs are myth-driven, so **strike-rewrite** leads (the UN/RE engine), with **sort** separating careful science from pseudo-science and **spot** catching myths in the wild. Mechanics rotate; the same one never runs twice in a row.

MECHANIC	THE TEEN DOES	EMBODIES	N
strike-rewrite (myth-flip) signature	Erases a gender myth, writes the evidence ("boys better at maths" → cultural, not biological).	Conceptual change.	31
sort	Sorts careful science vs pseudo-science; culture vs biology.	Science literacy.	15
reflect	Considers their own absorbed myths and what equality gives them.	Self-application.	12
branch	Chooses to fact-check a claim or back a fairer call.	Critical thinking.	11
match	Pairs a field to a real person who broke the myth.	Counter-examples.	7
role-play (voice)	Flips a myth in a chat; reframes "feminism = man-hating".	Allyship; voice.	7
spot	Spots the gender myth in a reel, a 'fact', an ad.	Media literacy; inoculation.	7

31 myths flipped, with strike-rewrite held under the 35% cap by design. Binary "tap the right answer": **0%**.

The two-test, passed.

Is it fun?

MythBuster: Gender plays like a satisfying debunking spree: a confident "fact" lands ("studies prove women are worse drivers"), and you get to strike it through and write the real evidence in its place, or catch it hiding in a reel and flip it. The "I knew that was nonsense" hit, plus a genuine respect for the player's intelligence (it never lectures), is what makes a heavy topic feel sharp and a bit thrilling.

Is it teaching?

Yes, gender-equality literacy and science literacy at once: that ability and leadership aren't gendered, that "it's just biology" is usually pseudo-science (and "natural" never means "right"), and that equality isn't men-versus-women but freedom for everyone.

The belief it moves. From "boys are just better at maths; men are natural leaders; feminism is man-hating; it's just science; equality means men lose" → "ability isn't gendered, the science says so; leadership is learned; equality is fairness for all; check the real evidence; and 'natural' never settles what's fair."

Built, not bolted on.

90 researched scenarios across the ability → roles → emotion/leadership → "science" → equality → spot-it arc, evidence-based and evenhanded. Full library in the companion JSON.

CATEGORY	N	LEAD MECHANICS	COVERS
Ability isn't gendered	18	strike-rewrite, sort, match	Maths/STEM, no 'male/female brain', sport, stereotype threat.
Roles aren't gendered	15	strike-rewrite, sort, match	"A woman's place", provider pressure, dads cook & care.
Emotion & leadership	14	strike-rewrite, sort	"Men don't cry", "too emotional to lead", "bossy girl".
"It's just science"	14	strike-rewrite, sort, branch	Naturalistic fallacy, averages vs individuals, pseudo-science.
What equality really means	15	strike-rewrite, branch, role-play	Feminism ≠ man-hating; not zero-sum; equality frees boys.
Spot it & flip it	14	spot, role-play, branch	Catch the myth in reels, 'facts' and ads; flip and call it out.

A maths myth-flip + a "just science" flip, verbatim.

flip: "Boys are just naturally better at maths."
 UN -> "Boys are naturally better at maths than girls."
 RE -> "There's no brain difference in maths ability; the gap is cultural, not biological."

flip: "It's just science, men are biologically meant to dominate."
 RE -> "There's no biological law that men must dominate; 'it's natural' never proves it's right."

Full library: [SwipeEd — GDD 25 MythBuster Gender — Scenario Library.json](#) (90 records, v2 schema).

What this game busts.

MYTH (UN ERASES)	EVIDENCE (RE WRITES)	BASIS
Boys are just naturally better at maths.	No brain difference; the gap is cultural, not biological.	Neuroscience.
There's a 'male brain' and a 'female brain'.	Brains overlap hugely; no neat split for ability.	Neuroscience.
Women are too emotional to lead.	Understanding emotions makes a stronger leader.	Leadership.
Men are just natural leaders.	Leadership is learned; India has had a woman PM and President.	Leadership (India).
It's just science, men are meant to dominate.	No such biological law; 'natural' never proves 'right'.	Naturalistic fallacy.
Feminism means hating men.	It's equal rights for all genders, men included.	Equality.
If women gain, men lose.	Equality isn't zero-sum; it frees everyone.	Equality.
A real man never cries.	Everyone feels; expressing emotion is healthy and strong.	Masculinity.

The micro-loop.

1. **Hook.** Lensy: "here's a 'fact' going round, true, or a myth?".
2. **Play.** Flip a myth (with evidence), sort science from pseudo-science, or spot a myth in a reel, rotated.
3. **The flip.** UN strikes the myth, RE writes the verified fact, often with a real counter-example.
4. **Even-handed beat.** Boys' struggles are named and taken seriously; equality is shown as their win too.
5. **Apply.** Flip a myth in a chat, fact-check a creator, or back a fairer call.
6. **Sticker.** The MythBuster badge; GameDone records once.

Signature surface: the **strike-and-rewrite card** with an evidence line, shared with Flip the Script (g17) and the gender thread, here tuned to meet pseudo-science with real science. It sets up The Rabbit Hole (g43), the deeper manosphere-inoculation node.

Evidence-based, never anti-boy.

- **Register.** Ages 12-15, real and respectful of the player's intelligence; it argues with evidence, not scolding.
- **Never anti-boy.** It takes boys' struggles seriously, shows myths hurt boys too, and never blames or shames boys for what they've absorbed.
- **Real science, honestly.** It meets "it's just science" with actual research and the naturalistic fallacy, modelling how to think, not just what to conclude.
- **Equality as everyone's win.** Equality is framed as freedom for all, not a contest where one side loses.
- **Inoculation, not lecture.** By teaching teens to spot the agenda and check evidence, it builds resistance to the manosphere pipeline (and links to g43).
- **Access.** Audio-first, offline; India-grounded (women leaders, the reservation law); builds on Norm Storm (g18).

v2 schema, scorecard-gated.

- **gameld. mythbuster-gender** — node.game === GameDone key === registry id (confirm exact id in engine-host).
- **v2 mechanic-embodiment schema.** type + typed payload; **strike-rewrite** leads (myth: un / re / why, carrying the evidence), with **sort** and **spot** doing science- and media-literacy.
- **Fact-checked content.** The maths/brain debunk, India women-leadership facts and the naturalistic-fallacy framing verified; flag edits for re-verification.
- **Scorecard-gated.** Passed all eight checks (7 mechanics, strike-rewrite at 34%, 0% binary, 18 autonomy, 31 UN→RE, 5 personas, 100% completeness). Re-run score_gdd.py on any edit.
- **Reuse.** The myth-flip and spot engines are shared with Flip the Script (g17), Equalize (g26) and The Rabbit Hole (g43).
- **Tracked.** sync_master_tracker.py marks g25 v2 PASS in the Master Node Table.
- **Generated path.** Label/order/thread changes flow through the xlsx + gen-path, never hand-edited path.ts.

Ethics contracts (never traded for engagement): evidence over assertion; never anti-boy; equality is everyone's win; meet 'science' with real science; inoculate, don't lecture; made-for-India.

Why this works.

- **The 'science' myths are the strongest and the most beatable.** Because claims like "boys are better at maths" pose as fact, busting them with the actual evidence (no brain-network gap; the gap is cultural) is both the most persuasive and the most needed move, so myth-flipping leads.
- **Counter-examples and the naturalistic fallacy do the heavy lifting.** Real women leaders and scientists, plus the rule that "natural never proves right", dismantle pseudo-science without needing a lecture, which the match and sort scenarios deliver.
- **Evenhandedness is what reaches the at-risk kid.** Because attacking boys pushes them toward the very pipeline this counters, the game takes their struggles seriously and frames equality as their win, the design choice most likely to actually change minds.

Sources: research debunking the maths/brain gender gap (no neural difference; gap is cultural); UN Women / Government of India on the 2023 Women's Reservation Act and women's leadership. Citations accompany each scenario in the library JSON. 29 games now v2. Next in Chapter 4: Equalize (g26).